RULE OR EXCEPTION?

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Fifteen common words break the FLOSS rule. Read them, then decide for each word at the bottom: does it follow the rule (R) or is it an exception (E)?

THE FIFTEEN EXCEPTIONS

The s sounds like /z/	is, as, has, was, his	Say them: the s buzzes like a z. They are old, very common words and they never doubled.
Short words ending in one s	us, bus, gas, yes, plus, this	These do end in a hissing s after a short vowel, and the rule still does not apply. Learn them by sight.
One l, not two	pal, nil	Both came into English late, from other languages, so they never took the double l.
One f, not two	if, of	Two of the most common words in the language. In **of** the f even sounds like a v.

RULE WORD (R) OR EXCEPTION (E)? TICK ONE BOX FOR EACH WORD.

		R	E			R	E
1.	bell	☐	☐	8.	was	☐	☐
2.	bus	☐	☐	9.	floss	☐	☐
3.	grass	☐	☐	10.	this	☐	☐
4.	if	☐	☐	11.	buzz	☐	☐
5.	miss	☐	☐	12.	pal	☐	☐
6.	gas	☐	☐	13.	spell	☐	☐
7.	cliff	☐	☐	14.	yes	☐	☐

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RULE OR EXCEPTION? ANSWER KEY

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RULE WORD (R) OR EXCEPTION (E)? TICK ONE BOX FOR EACH WORD.

		R	E
1.	bell	R	
2.	bus		E
3.	grass	R	
4.	if		E
5.	miss	R	
6.	gas		E
7.	cliff	R	
8.	was		E
9.	floss	R	
10.	this		E
11.	buzz	R	
12.	pal		E
13.	spell	R	
14.	yes		E

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